

# Building Your Mission Control

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OpenClaw Masterclass — Lesson Guide & All Prompts

## What you'll build in this lesson:

- Mission Control dashboard — a custom Next.js web app built by your agent
- Dark interface styled like Linear with sidebar navigation
- Running in production mode for stability
- Accessible from your browser (localhost for local, SSH tunnel for VPS)

**VPS users (e.g. Hostinger):** You'll need to add a port mapping in Docker Manager and use an SSH tunnel through Tailscale. Full steps included below.

**Local users:** Just open localhost:3007 in your browser. No extra setup needed.

# All Prompts Used In This Lesson

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Copy and paste these prompts into Telegram in order.

## Prompt 1: Build Mission Control

*I want my own Mission Control dashboard where we can build custom tools. Build it in Next.js and host it on localhost port 3007. Make it a clean dark interface that looks like Linear or Trello. For now just set up the foundation with a sidebar navigation and a home page that shows some basic stats. We're going to add the individual screens in the next lessons. Build it for production and run it with npm start, not dev mode, so it stays stable and doesn't crash. Tell me when it's up.*

The agent will build the app, compile it for production, and start it. This may take a few minutes.

## Prompt 2: Restart After Port Mapping (VPS only)

*The Docker container just restarted because I added port 3007 to the port mapping. Restart the Mission Control dashboard on port 3007 in production mode and confirm when it's up.*

Use this after adding the port mapping in Hostinger Docker Manager (see VPS setup below).

## Prompt 3: Clear Demo Data

*Clear any demo data or sample content from the Mission Control dashboard. I want it clean and empty so we can build it up ourselves step by step.*

The agent may populate the dashboard with sample data from your conversations. Use this to start clean.

## Prompt 4: Screenshot Trick (VPS users without tunnel)

*Take a screenshot of the Mission Control dashboard and send it to me here on Telegram.*

If you're on a VPS and don't have the SSH tunnel set up yet, use this to see what your dashboard looks like. Not interactive, but lets you preview the result.

## Prompt 5: Restart Mission Control (if it crashes)

*Mission Control is down. Restart it on port 3007 in production mode.*

Use this any time Mission Control stops responding. The server can sometimes crash, especially before PM2 is set up.

# VPS Setup: Port Mapping & SSH Tunnel

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If you're running OpenClaw on a VPS (e.g. Hostinger), Mission Control runs inside the Docker container on port 3007. Docker doesn't expose this port by default, so you need to add it manually and then use an SSH tunnel to access it from your browser.

## Step 1: Add Port Mapping in Hostinger

1. Go to your Hostinger VPS dashboard
2. Click **Docker Manager** on the left
3. Click **Manage** next to your OpenClaw project
4. Click **Edit** on the container
5. In the **Ports** section, click **+ Port**
6. Type **3007:3007**
7. Click **Save**
8. Scroll up and click **Deploy**

**Important:** Clicking Deploy will restart the container, which stops Mission Control. After deploying, use Prompt 2 above to tell your agent to restart it.

## Step 2: Open SSH Tunnel

Open a new terminal on your computer and run:

```
ssh -N -L 3007:127.0.0.1:3007 root@YOUR_TAILSCALE_IP
```

Replace **YOUR\_TAILSCALE\_IP** with your server's Tailscale IP (starts with 100). Find it in the Tailscale app under Network Devices.

The terminal will sit silently — that's normal. It means the tunnel is open.

## Step 3: Open in Browser

Go to your browser and open:

```
http://localhost:3007
```

You should see your Mission Control dashboard.

**Tip:** The tunnel only stays open as long as the terminal window is open. Close the terminal = close the tunnel. Just run the command again when you need it.

## Important Notes

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### Agent may go quiet for several minutes

When building something big like Mission Control, the agent writes a lot of code, creates files, and compiles the production bundle. It can go silent for 3-5 minutes. This is completely normal. If it's been more than 5 minutes, just ask: 'Are you still working on this?' and it will give you a status update.

### Mission Control can crash

The server can sometimes stop running, especially before PM2 is set up (covered in the next lesson). If your browser shows 'connection refused' or 'didn't send any data', just tell your agent: 'Mission Control is down. Restart it on port 3007 in production mode.' The agent will restart it in seconds.

### Agent may add demo data from your conversations

When building the dashboard, the agent might pull context from your User.md and previous conversations to populate sample tasks, projects, or other data. This is helpful to see how things look, but clear it before the next lessons so you start fresh.

### Screenshot trick for VPS users

If you're on a VPS and don't have the SSH tunnel set up yet, you can ask your agent to take a screenshot of the dashboard and send it to you on Telegram. It won't be interactive but it lets you preview what was built while you're setting up the tunnel.

### Build errors are normal

The agent may hit errors during the build process. Don't panic — it will usually spot the error and fix it on its own. Just let it work through it.

## Tips & Troubleshooting

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| Situation                               | What to do                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Agent goes quiet for a long time        | This is normal when building apps. Wait 5 minutes, then ask: 'Are you still working on this?'                                              |
| Agent hits a build error                | Don't panic. The agent will usually spot and fix the error on its own. Let it work through it.                                             |
| Mission Control not loading in browser  | Check: 1) Is the SSH tunnel still running? 2) Did you add port 3007 in Docker Manager? 3) Is MC running? Ask agent to restart it.          |
| Browser shows 'connection refused'      | Mission Control is probably down. Tell your agent: 'Restart Mission Control on port 3007 in production mode.'                              |
| Agent added demo/sample data            | Use Prompt 3 to clear it. The agent sometimes populates the dashboard with example data from your conversations.                           |
| Can't see dashboard but on VPS          | Ask your agent to take a screenshot and send it via Telegram: 'Take a screenshot of the Mission Control dashboard and send it to me here.' |
| Port 3007 already in use (tunnel error) | You have an old tunnel open. Run: <code>lsof -ti:3007   xargs kill</code> — then try the tunnel again.                                     |
| Running locally, not on VPS             | Skip the Docker Manager and SSH tunnel steps. Just open <code>localhost:3007</code> in your browser.                                       |

## What You've Built

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- ✓ Mission Control dashboard built by your agent from a single prompt
- ✓ Dark Linear-style interface with sidebar navigation
- ✓ Running in production mode (`npm build + npm start`) for stability
- ✓ Port 3007 exposed in Docker Manager (VPS users)
- ✓ SSH tunnel set up for browser access (VPS users)
- ✓ Clean empty dashboard ready for adding screens in the next lessons